

Pre-Listing Prep & Styling Checklist — Queensland

Getting your property market-ready without overspending on the wrong things.

Correct as at July 2026. General information only, not legal, financial or valuation advice.

Section 1 — Before You Spend Anything

- ☐ [] **Start your Seller Disclosure Statement and certificates early.** Since this is now mandatory before a buyer can sign (since 1 August 2025), engage your solicitor or conveyancer as one of your very first steps, well before your first open home.
- ☐ [] **Get a professional appraisal from 2-3 agents** before deciding your preparation budget.
- ☐ [] **Decide: renovate, style, or sell as-is?** Major renovations rarely return their cost dollar-for-dollar in a short pre-sale timeframe.

Section 2 — High-Return, Low-Cost Improvements

- ☐ [] **Declutter aggressively** — consistently the highest-return, lowest-cost step.
- ☐ [] **Deep clean throughout**, paying particular attention to mould and mildew given Queensland's humidity — visible mould is a red flag that costs you buyer confidence fast.
- ☐ [] **Fix small, visible defects** — leaking taps, cracked tiles, chipped paint, and anything storm/water-damage related.
- ☐ [] **Freshen paint in neutral tones** where walls are marked or dated.
- ☐ [] **Improve street appeal** — including tidying tropical gardens/lawns, which can grow quickly and look unkempt fast in Queensland's climate if neglected pre-listing.

Section 3 — Styling Decisions

- ☐ [] **Consider professional staging for vacant properties.**
- ☐ [] **For occupied properties, focus on de-personalising** rather than full staging.
- ☐ [] **Get professional photography and floor plans regardless of styling budget** — not an area to cut costs on.
- ☐ [] **Ask your agent for their honest opinion on styling ROI** for your specific property.

Section 4 — Compliance and Disclosure Items to Check Before Listing

- ☐ [] **Prepare your Seller Disclosure Statement (Form 2) and prescribed certificates** — this is now a prerequisite, not an optional nicety, and delays here can hold up your whole campaign.
- ☐ [] **Check smoke alarm compliance.**
- ☐ [] **If in a body corporate scheme, gather your records** — recent AGM minutes, financials, and any known disputes or special levies, which buyers' solicitors will request as part of their own due diligence.
- ☐ [] **Address any known structural, water damage, or pest issues honestly** — under the new disclosure regime, undisclosed material matters can now give a buyer grounds to walk away and reclaim their deposit, so it's genuinely in your interest to be upfront rather than hope an issue goes unnoticed.

Section 5 — Timing Your Campaign

- ☐ [] **Discuss timing with your agent relative to market conditions and Queensland's seasonal patterns.**
- ☐ [] **Align your preparation and disclosure timeline with your agent's proposed campaign start** — given the new disclosure requirement, this now needs more lead time than Queensland sellers may be used to from before August 2025.
- ☐ [] **Plan your own moving logistics in parallel** — see the separate Pre-Settlement Checklist in this series.

Quick Reference — Where to Spend, Where to Save

HIGH-RETURN, LOW-COST	OFTEN LOWER-RETURN RELATIVE TO COST
Decluttering	Full kitchen/bathroom renovations
Deep cleaning (esp. mould/mildew)	High-end fixture upgrades
Minor repairs	Structural changes shortly before sale
Professional photography	Extensive landscaping overhauls
Fresh neutral paint (where needed)	Full furniture replacement for occupied homes

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